Ordinals and Typed Lambda Calculus
Numeral Systems in the Lambda Calculus

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Church Encoding

Booleans

We encoding the Booleans.

$$\mathsf{true} := \lambda\, x\, y.\, x, \text{ where } \mathsf{true}\, M\, N =_\beta M.$$
$$\mathsf{false} := \lambda\, x\, y.\, y, \text{ where } \mathsf{false}\, M\, N =_\beta N.$$

Church Encoding

Definition

For $n \in \mathbb{N}$ and $F, M \in \Delta$, we define

$$F^0\, M := M,$$
$$F^{n+1}\, M := F\,(F^n\, M).$$

Church Encoding

Definition

The **Church numerals**, denoted by c_n with $n \in \mathbb{N}$, encode the natural numbers.

- One definition

$$\mathsf{c}_n \coloneqq \lambda\, f\, x.\, f^n\, x,$$

- Other definition

$$\begin{aligned} \mathsf{c}_0 &\coloneqq \lambda\, f\, x.\, x, \\ \mathsf{succ} &\coloneqq \lambda\, n\, f\, x.\, f\, (n\, f\, x), \\ \mathsf{c}_{n+1} &\coloneqq \mathsf{succ}\, \mathsf{c}_n. \end{aligned}$$

Church Encoding

Example

β-nf's for some numerals.

$$\begin{aligned}
\mathsf{c}_0 &=_\beta \lambda f\, x.\, x, \\
\mathsf{c}_1 &=_\beta \lambda f\, x.\, f\, x, \\
\mathsf{c}_2 &=_\beta \lambda f\, x.\, f\, (f\, x), \\
\mathsf{c}_3 &=_\beta \lambda f\, x.\, f\, (f\, (f\, x)).
\end{aligned}$$

Whiteboard.

Church Encoding

Addition, multiplication and exponentiation

Encoding for the arithmetic operations.

$$\mathsf{add} := \lambda\, m\, n\, f\, x.\, m\, f\, (n\, f\, x), \text{ where} \qquad \mathsf{add}\ \mathsf{c}_m\ \mathsf{c}_n =_\beta \mathsf{c}_{m+n}.$$

$$\begin{aligned}\mathsf{mult} &:= \lambda\, m\, n\, f\, x.\, m\, (n\, f)\, x \\ &\equiv \lambda\, m\, n\, f.\, m\, (n\, f), \text{ where}\end{aligned} \qquad \mathsf{mult}\ \mathsf{c}_m\ \mathsf{c}_n =_\beta \mathsf{c}_{m\times n}.$$

$$\mathsf{exp} := \lambda\, m\, n\, f\, x.\, (n\, m)\, f\, x, \text{ where} \qquad \mathsf{exp}\ \mathsf{c}_m\ \mathsf{c}_n =_\beta \mathsf{c}_{m^n}.$$

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Testing for zero

A combinator for testing for zero is defined by

$$\mathsf{isZero} := \lambda n.\, n\,(\lambda x.\mathsf{false})\,\mathsf{true},$$

where

$$\begin{aligned} \mathsf{isZero}\,\mathsf{c}_0 &=_\beta \mathsf{true}, \\ \mathsf{isZero}\,\mathsf{c}_{n+1} &=_\beta \mathsf{false}. \end{aligned}$$

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Predecessor

A predecessor combinator is defined by

$$\mathsf{pred} := \lambda\, n\, f\, x.\, n\, (\lambda\, g\, h.\, h\, (g\, f))\, (\lambda u.x)\, (\lambda u.u),$$

where

$$\begin{aligned} \mathsf{pred}\, \mathsf{c}_0 &=_\beta \mathsf{c}_0, \\ \mathsf{pred}\, \mathsf{c}_{n+1} &=_\beta \mathsf{c}_n. \end{aligned}$$

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Recursion

The factorial function is an example of recursive functions on natural numbers following the schemata

$$\begin{aligned} f &: \mathbb{N} \to A \\ f\,0 &= a \\ f\,(\mathrm{S}\,n) &= g\,n\,(f\,n) \end{aligned}$$

where A is a set, $a \in A$, $g \colon \mathbb{N} \to A \to A$ and S is the successor function.

Remark

A reader familiarised with recursion theory will identify the primitive recursion schemata.

Church Encoding

A recursor for natural numbers

Let A be a set. From the previous schemata for (primitive) recursive functions, we define a recursor.[†]

$$\begin{aligned} \mathrm{rec} &: (\mathbb{N} \to A \to A) \to A \to \mathbb{N} \to A \\ \mathrm{rec}\, f\, a\, 0 &= a \\ \mathrm{rec}\, f\, a\, (\mathrm{S}\, n) &= f\, n\, (\mathrm{rec}\, f\, a\, n) \end{aligned}$$

[†] A higher-order function which allow define recursive functions.

Church Encoding

Recursor

Since rec is also a recursive function, we can define a recursor for numerals using fix.

$$\begin{aligned} \mathsf{h} &:= \lambda\, r\, f\, a\, n.\, (\mathsf{isZero}\, n)\, a\, (f\, (\mathsf{pred}\, n)\, (r\, f\, a\, (\mathsf{pred}\, n)))), \\ \mathsf{rec} &:= \mathsf{fix}\, \mathsf{h}, \end{aligned}$$

where

$$\begin{aligned} \mathsf{rec}\, f\, a\, \mathsf{c}_0 &=_\beta a, \\ \mathsf{rec}\, f\, a\, \mathsf{c}_{n+1} &=_\beta f\, \mathsf{c}_n\, (\mathsf{rec}\, f\, a\, \mathsf{c}_n). \end{aligned}$$

Church Encoding

Recursor

Since rec is also a recursive function, we can define a recursor for numerals using fix.

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where

$$\begin{aligned} \mathsf{rec}\, f\, a\, \mathsf{c}_0 &=_\beta a, \\ \mathsf{rec}\, f\, a\, \mathsf{c}_{n+1} &=_\beta f\, \mathsf{c}_n\, (\mathsf{rec}\, f\, a\, \mathsf{c}_n). \end{aligned}$$

Question

What is it necessary for defining rec? A fixed-point combinator, (implicit) 'Boolean' case analysis, a test for zero and a predecessor function.

Church Encoding

Example

A combinator for the factorial function

$$\begin{aligned} \mathrm{fac} &: \mathbb{N} \to \mathbb{N} \\ \mathrm{fac}\,0 &= 1 \\ \mathrm{fac}\,(\mathrm{S}\,n) &= \mathrm{S}\,n \times \mathrm{fac}\,n \end{aligned}$$

is defined by

$$\mathsf{fac} \coloneqq \mathsf{rec}\,(\lambda\, x\, y.\, \mathsf{mult}\,(\mathsf{succ}\, x)\, y)\,\mathsf{c}_1.$$

Church Encoding

Definition

A **number-theoretic function** is a function whose signature is

$$\mathbb{N}^k \to \mathbb{N}, \text{ with } k \in \mathbb{N}.$$

Church Encoding

Definition

Let φ be a partial number-theoretic function $\varphi\colon \mathbb{N}^k \to \mathbb{N}$. The function φ is λ-**definable respect to the Church encoding** if there exists a λ-term F such that for all $n_1, \ldots, n_k \in \mathbb{N}$,

$$\varphi(n_1, \ldots, n_k) = a \Rightarrow F\,\mathsf{c}_{n_1} \ldots \mathsf{c}_{n_k} =_\beta \mathsf{c}_a,$$
$$\varphi(n_1, \ldots, n_k) \text{ does not exits} \Rightarrow F\,\mathsf{c}_{n_1} \ldots \mathsf{c}_{n_k} \text{ has no } \beta\text{-nf}.$$

[†] See, e.g., (Barendregt [1981] 2004, Corollary 6.4.6) and (Hindley and Seldin 2008, Theorem 4.23).

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Theorem

The Turing-computable functions are λ-definable respect to the Church encoding.[†]

[†] See, e.g., (Barendregt [1981] 2004, Corollary 6.4.6) and (Hindley and Seldin 2008, Theorem 4.23).

Numeral Systems

Definition

A **numeral system** is a sequence of combinators

$$\mathsf{d} = \mathsf{d}_0, \mathsf{d}_1, \ldots$$

and combinators true_d, $\mathsf{false}_\mathsf{d}$, succ_d and $\mathsf{isZero}_\mathsf{d}$ such that for all $n \in \mathbb{N}$ (Barendregt [1981] 2004, Definition 6.4.1),

$$\begin{aligned} \mathsf{succ}_\mathsf{d}\,\mathsf{d}_n &=_\beta \mathsf{d}_{n+1}, \\ \mathsf{isZero}_\mathsf{d}\,\mathsf{d}_0 &=_\beta \mathsf{true}_\mathsf{d}, \\ \mathsf{isZero}_\mathsf{d}\,\mathsf{d}_{n+1} &=_\beta \mathsf{false}_\mathsf{d}. \end{aligned}$$

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Example

The Church numerals $\mathsf{c} = \mathsf{c}_0, \mathsf{c}_1, \ldots$ and the combinators true, false, succ and isZero are a numeral system.

Numeral Systems

Notation

We shall denote by d a numeral system d_0, d_1, ..., true_d, $\mathsf{false}_\mathsf{d}$, succ_d and $\mathsf{isZero}_\mathsf{d}$.

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Lambda definable functions on a numeral system

Let d be a numeral system and let φ be a partial number-theoretic function $\varphi\colon \mathbb{N}^k \to \mathbb{N}$. The function φ is λ-**definable respect to the numeral system** d if there exists a λ-term F such that for all $n_1, \ldots, n_k \in \mathbb{N}$,

$$\varphi(n_1, \ldots, n_k) = a \Rightarrow F\,\mathsf{d}_{n_1} \ldots \mathsf{d}_{n_k} =_\beta \mathsf{d}_a,$$
$$\varphi(n_1, \ldots, n_k) \text{ does not exits} \Rightarrow F\,\mathsf{d}_{n_1} \ldots \mathsf{d}_{n_k} \text{ has no } \beta\text{-nf}.$$

Numeral Systems

Definition

A numeral system d is **adequate** if all the Turing-computable functions are λ-definable with respect to d (Barendregt [1981] 2004, Definition 6.4.2ii).

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Example

The Church numeral system is adequate.

Numeral Systems

Theorem

A numeral system d is adequate if there exists a combinator $\mathsf{pred_d}$ such that for all $n \in \mathbb{N}$ (Barendregt [1981] 2004, Theorem 6.4.3),

$$\mathsf{pred_d}\ \mathsf{d}_{n+1} =_\beta \mathsf{d}_n.$$

Numeral Systems

Theorem

A numeral system d is adequate if there exists a combinator $\mathsf{pred_d}$ such that for all $n \in \mathbb{N}$ (Barendregt [1981] 2004, Theorem 6.4.3),

$$\mathsf{pred_d}\,\mathsf{d}_{n+1} =_\beta \mathsf{d}_n.$$

Remark

There are various adequate numeral systems in the literature. See, e.g., Barendregt ([1981] 2004), Goldberg (2000) and Jansen (2013).

References

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